



11th Grade English Language Arts

English 3 (Florida course 1001370) · Full year, delivered as two semester sections · The individual and society: freedom, truth, justice, conformity, and power

~4¼ hrs
per week
50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Rooted in the classical tradition and focused on the American experience, 11th Grade ELA examines the relationship between the individual and society through four anchor works: two dystopias (*Fahrenheit 451*, *Brave New World*), Steinbeck's *The Grapes of Wrath*, and Shakespeare's *Hamlet*, joined by the Federalist Papers, nonfiction, and poetry. Scholars read closely, discuss in Socratic style, and write in every register: weekly analytical paragraphs that build toward quarterly essays, formal arguments on questions like "Is truth more important than comfort?", research that connects each book to the present, and creative work in character voices. Weekly VR experiences bring the texts to life, and the year closes with a portfolio and public exhibition of the scholar's best work.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 4 QUARTERS · 36 WEEKS

Quarter · Theme	Weeks	Texts, focus & major work
Q1 · Censorship, Rebellion & Society	9	<i>Fahrenheit 451</i> , opening with a welcome week on digital literacy, AI, and plagiarism; then a 3-week study of the Federalist Papers bridging into Q2; literary analysis essay built from weekly paragraphs
Q2 · Control, Identity & the Cost of Stability	9	<i>Brave New World</i> with modern connections (technology, AI, social conformity); rhetorical analysis of propaganda; argumentative essay: truth vs. stability + a synthesis and public presentation week
Q3 · Civilization & Corruption	9	<i>The Grapes of Wrath</i> , opened by a Dust Bowl history week; research linking Depression-era issues to the present; literary analysis essay + migrant-voice creative writing and the "American Voices in Hard Times" VR showcase
Q4 · Madness, Power & the Human Psyche	9	<i>Hamlet</i> act by act, then the poetry of madness (Dickinson, Poe, Plath) and modern comparisons; soliloquy performance, comparative essay, final portfolio + public exhibition

A TYPICAL WEEK

Strand	What the scholar does (~50 min/day, M–F)
Read	The week's portion of the anchor text, read closely with a stated theme focus (e.g., "Technology & Alienation," "Sanity and Revenge").
Write	A weekly written product: an analytical paragraph, reading response, character piece, or essay-draft step that builds toward the quarter's essay.
Discuss	Socratic discussion or seminar on the week's essential question.
VR	A weekly VR experience on Optima's VR campus: world-building, monologue booths, Hooverville scenes, the ghost on the battlements.
Style	Grammar and style mini-lessons embedded in the writing work: embedding quotations, transitions, syntax and tone.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week is the school's designated planning figure for this course: about 50 minutes a day, Monday through Friday. Reading and the weekly writing are the core of that time. **Essay and portfolio weeks** can run longer, and slower readers should budget extra time for *The Grapes of Wrath* and *Hamlet*.

THE WRITING ARC

- ▶ **Literary analysis** every quarter: thesis, embedded evidence, author's purpose, built from weekly paragraphs to multi-paragraph essays
- ▶ **Argument:** formal essays with claims and counterclaims on real questions (Is ignorance bliss? Does freedom require suffering? Is the American Dream equally accessible?)
- ▶ **Research & synthesis:** annotated bibliographies and source-based writing connecting each book to modern issues
- ▶ **Creative & performance:** monologues, character journals, scene adaptations, and recorded performances
- ▶ A year-end **portfolio** gathers and publishes the best of all four strands

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ Copies of the four anchor texts (the teacher's section confirms editions and provided readings)
- ▶ A computer with a web browser and a **microphone** for recorded monologues and performances
- ▶ **VR headset** for Optima's VR campus: one VR experience most weeks
- ▶ OneDrive (Microsoft 365) for essays, multimedia projects, and the portfolio

A NOTE ON AI

- ▶ The course opens with a digital literacy unit, and expectations for honest, appropriate AI use are set in week one and revisited when the dystopias raise the question directly

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback on writing, and grading.

Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.